



Inspection Report

Harvard University
16 DIVINITY AVENUE
ROOM 2102
CAMBRIDGE, MA 02138

Customer ID: **156**
Certificate: **14-R-0128**
Site: 001
HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Type: FOCUSED INSPECTION
Date: 24-MAR-2026

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Repeat

Miscellaneous.

One Rhabdomys pumilio mouse was not handled as carefully as possible by investigator staff during cage change on 7/28/25. The adult mice and their 7-9 day old litter were transferred to a clean cage, and the dirty cage/bedding was then processed for sanitization. After the enclosure was processed, technicians found one pup was deceased. Veterinary staff were immediately contacted and concluded that the pup was already dead when the adults and the litter were transferred to the clean enclosure. This conclusion was based on the physical appearance of the pup and the more rapid development of this species of mice after birth; 7-9 day old Rhabdomys pups are active, have open eyes, are fully furred, and behave similarly to an adult.

Per this Section, the handling of animals by all personnel should be done as carefully as possible in a manner that does not cause physical harm or unnecessary discomfort. The deceased Rhabdomys pup was not handled as carefully as possible during cage transfer when investigator staff did not thoroughly check the bedding of the dirty cage prior to the cage being processed for sanitization. This incident was voluntarily reported to USDA and corrective measures were implemented prior to this inspection, which included the retraining of investigator and animal care staff on the Rhabdomys dirty cage change procedure and modifying the procedures for changing and processing dirty cages by incorporating additional checks at each phase of the procedures. No additional incidents have occurred.

This inspection and exit briefing were conducted with facility representatives.

END OF REPORT

Prepared By: PAULA GLADUE
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Date:
25-MAR-2026

Received by Title: Attending Veterinarian

Date:
25-MAR-2026



Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
156	14-R-0128	001	HARVARD UNIVERSITY	24-MAR-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000192	<i>Rhabdomys pumilio</i>	FOUR-STRIPED GRASS MOUSE
000192	Total	